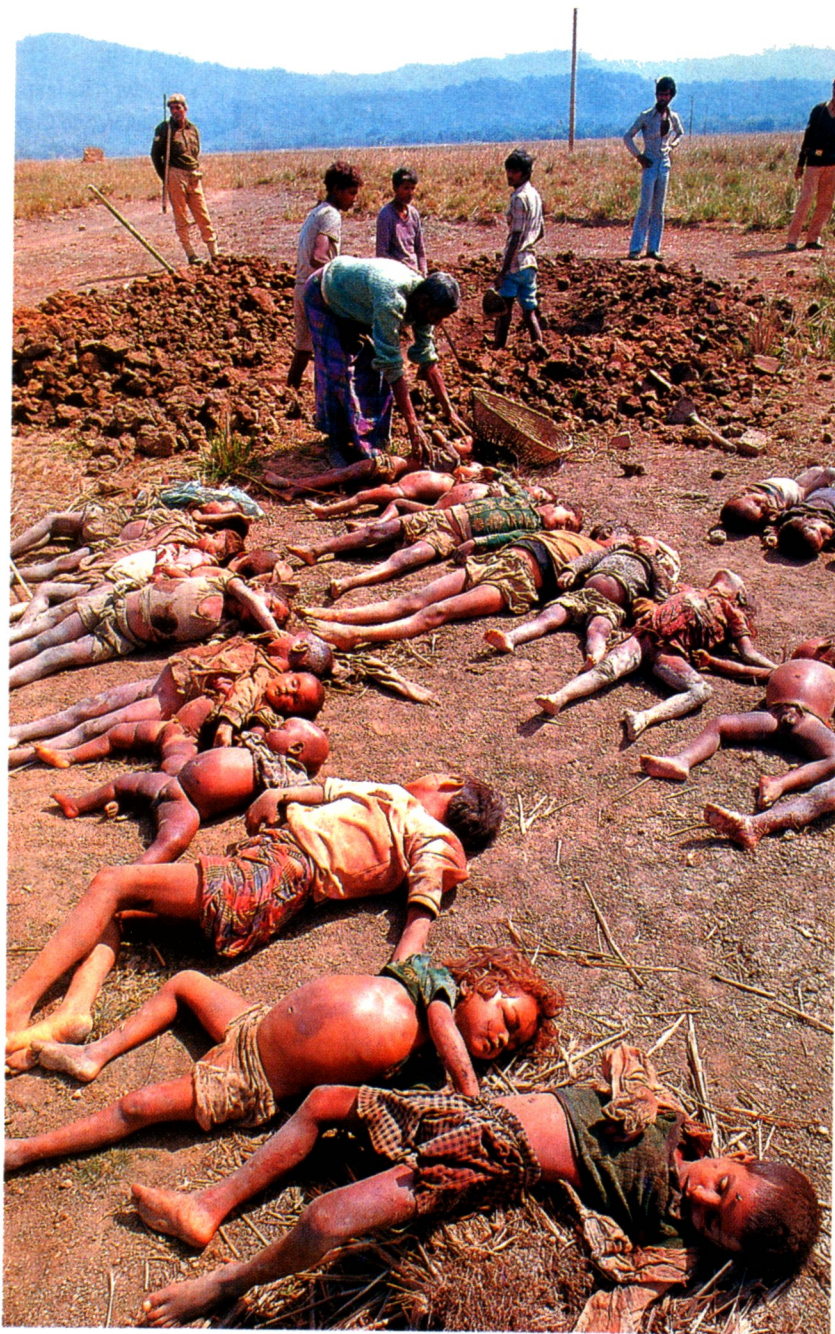


1983

SIMMERING FIRES

BHAWAN SINGH



The tension between indigenous Assamese and immigrants from Bangladesh had been building for some time in the run-up to the 1983 assembly elections in Assam. Led by the All Assam Students Union, sporadic violence continued to erupt, culminating in the horrific events on February 18, at Nellie in Nagaon District, when a blood-thirsty mob went on a killing spree, leaving 3,000 dead in less than 24 hours. The trigger may have been ethnic but politics played a major role, with elections been forced on the state in the midst of a wide-spread anti-outsider agitation.

PIB PHOTO



FOR NAM'S SAKE

India played host to the high and mighty of the world when the Seventh Non-Aligned Summit (NAM) was held in Delhi between March 7 and 12. Over 100 member-nations participated in the summit and later in the year, leaders from across the world converged on the city for the Commonwealth Heads of Government Meeting.

FIRST CUT

India launched its first successful multi-purpose communication and

meteorology satellite, INSAT-1B, on August 30 from Cape Canaveral, in Florida, US.